

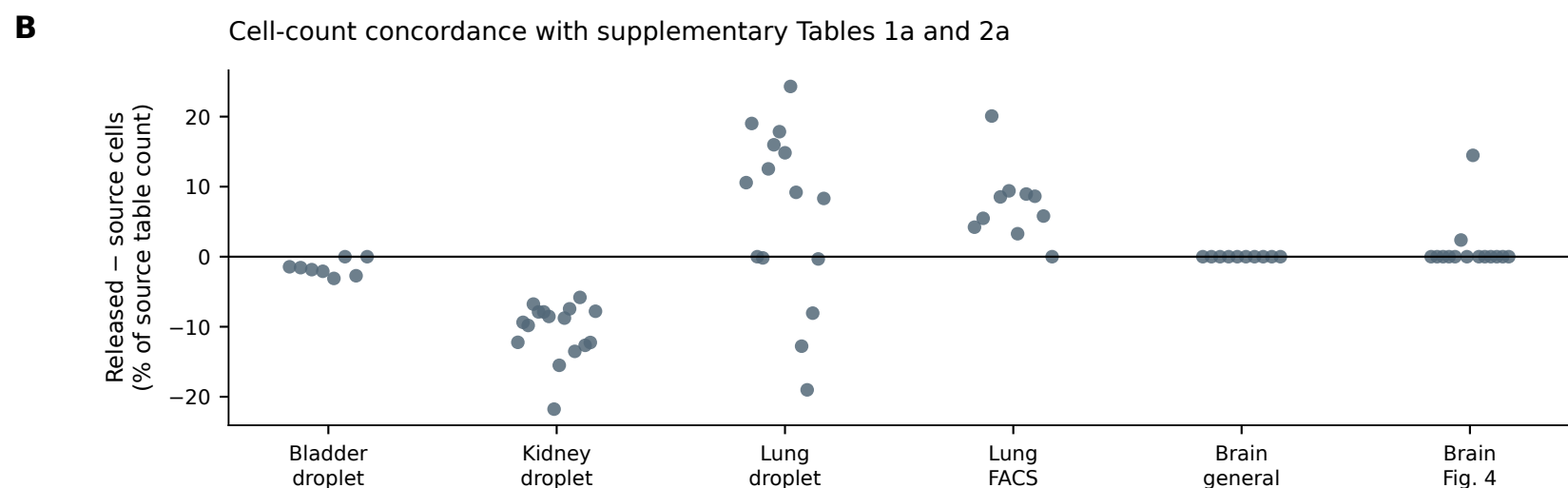
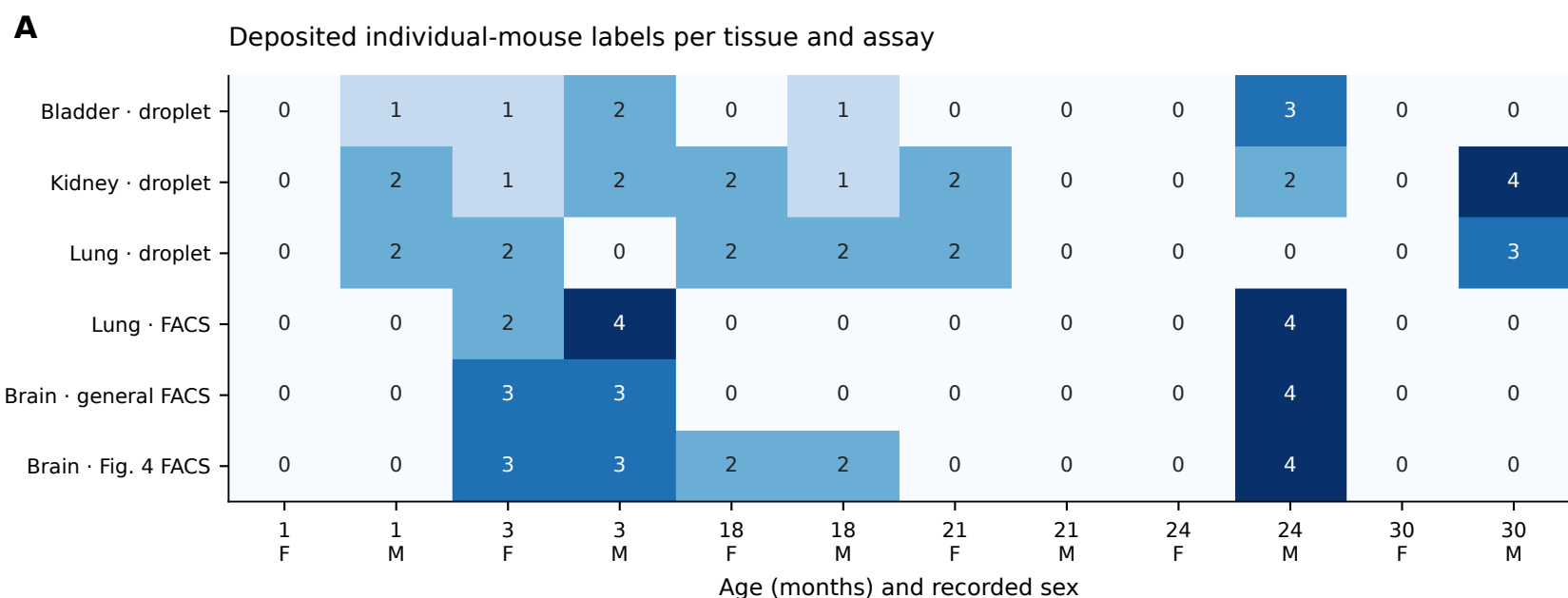


Figure 1 | Source qualification defines which ageing comparisons are supported.

Rationale: An apparent age-associated cellular change can reflect the animals sampled, sex composition or a different data release. Establishing the biological units and source concordance is therefore necessary before interpreting ageing effects.

A, numbers of deposited individual-mouse labels by tissue, assay, age and recorded sex. Two pooled young lung droplet libraries are excluded from these counts; tissues, assays and the two brain objects can share mice. B, each point is the difference between a released tissue-mouse cell count and supplementary Table 1a or 2a, expressed as a percentage of the supplementary count.

Results: All 73 source records join, but 47 have different cell totals. No 24-month female is represented in these objects, and lung droplet has no 24-month sample. The Figure 4 brain deposit adds 18-month observations absent from the general brain object. These gaps restrict sex-interaction and cross-assay contrasts; repeated tissues and releases do not supply independent replication. The figure qualifies the design and does not measure a biological ageing effect.